Resilience Academy

SDI Training for ICT Professionals

CRD Customisation

Make CRD Yours — All Through the Web Browser

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Day 2 | 30 Minutes (Lecture) | crd.resilienceacademy.ac.tz

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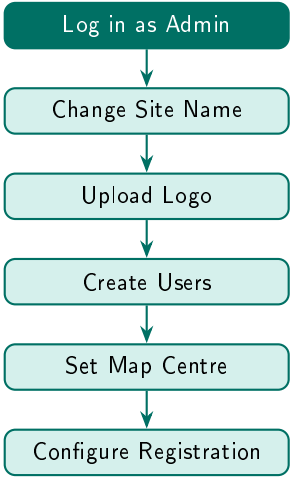
Session Overview: Make CRD Yours

Right now, your CRD looks like a blank template. In this session, you will learn how to personalise it for your institution.

Everything we cover today is done through the web browser — no code, no terminal, no configuration files.

What we will cover:

1. Admin panel tour — what each section does
2. Changing the site name, domain, and logo
3. Managing users: accounts, roles, permissions
4. Map settings: default centre point and zoom
5. Registration settings: open vs. invite-only



Admin Panel Tour: What Each Section Does

How to get there:

1. Log in → Click your username (top-right)
2. Select **"Admin"** from the dropdown menu

Think of the admin panel like the settings app on your phone — it has sections for different things:

GeoNode Settings

- **Base**: Site name, keywords, default language
- **Layers**: Manage uploaded datasets

Authentication & Users

- **Users**: Create, edit, deactivate accounts
- **Groups**: Organise users into teams
- **Group Profiles**: Set group permissions and descriptions

Site Administration

- **Sites**: Set domain name and display name
- **People**: User profiles and contact info
- **Announcements**: Post messages to all users

Changing Site Name, Domain, and Logo

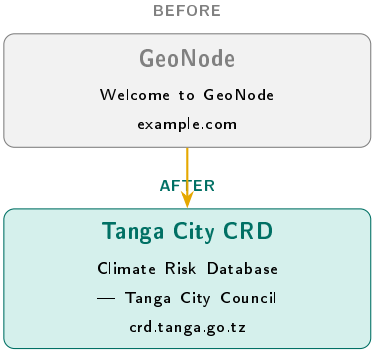
Step 1: Change the Site Name

1. In admin panel, go to **Sites** → **Sites**
2. Click on **"example.com"**
3. Change **Domain name** to your URL
   e.g. `localhost` or `crd.tanga.go.tz`
4. Change **Display name** to your institution's name
   e.g. "Tanga City Council — CRD"
5. Click **Save**

Step 2: Change the Logo

1. Go to **GeoNode** → **Base** → **Configuration**

Before and After:



Tip

Prepare your logo file **before** the practical

User Management: Accounts, Roles, Permissions

Creating a New User Account:

1. Admin panel → **Authentication** → **Users**
2. Click **"Add User"**
3. Fill in: username, password, email
4. Set **Staff status** if they need admin panel access
5. Click **Save**

The Four Permission Levels:

Viewer: Can browse and download public data

Editor: Can upload and edit own data

Groups — Organising Users by Team:

Groups let you set permissions for **entire teams** at once.

Example for Tanga City Council:

- Group: **"Planning Department"**
  - Can view and edit planning datasets
  - Cannot touch health or environment data
- Group: **"Environment Unit"**
  - Can view and edit environmental datasets
  - Can view (but not edit) planning data

Creating a Group

Map Settings: Default Centre Point and Zoom

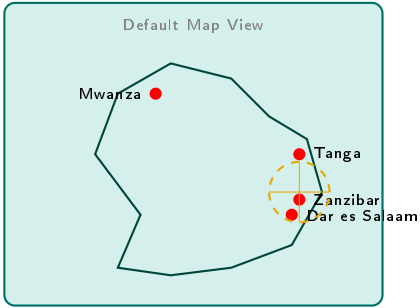
When users open the map viewer, CRD shows a **default location**. You should set this to your area of interest.

Coordinates for our training cities:

City	Latitude	Longitude
Tanga	−5.07	39.10
Mwanza	−2.50	32.90
Dar es Salaam	−6.79	39.28
Zanzibar	−6.16	39.19

How to set the default map centre:

1. Admin panel → **GeoNode** → **Base**
2. Find **"Map Settings"** or **"Default Map Center"**



Practical Tip

During the practical, **Tanga group** will set centre to $-5.07, 39.10$ and **Mwanza group** will set centre to $-2.50, 32.90$. This way each team's CRD opens showing their own city.

Registration Settings and Session Summary

Who can create an account on your CRD?

Option 1: Open Registration

- Anyone can create an account
- Good for **public-facing** CRD instances
- New users start as **Viewers** by default
- Admin can promote them later

Setting: Admin → Configuration → Registration: `Open`

Option 2: Invite-Only Registration

- Only admins can create accounts

Session Summary:

- ✓ The admin panel is your **control centre** — accessed through the web browser
- ✓ Change **site name and domain** under Sites
- ✓ Upload your **institution's logo** under Configuration
- ✓ Create **user accounts** and organise them into **groups** with appropriate permissions
- ✓ Set the **default map centre** to your city's coordinates
- ✓ Choose between **open** and **invite-only**